



Rajiv Gandhi National Institute of Youth Development

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Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, Government of India, Sriperumbudur 602105

Tamil Nadu

DEPARTMENT OF SOCIOLOGY

FIELDWORK CONSOLIDATED REPORT

ORGANIZATION: **REHOBOTH**

Submitted to

Department of Sociology

Under the Supervision of

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Submitted by

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DECLARATION

I, **FATHIMA RANA FOUMI** hereby declare that the fieldwork report is prepared by me under the supervision of **DR Avinu Veronica Richa**, Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology, Rajiv Gandhi National Institute of Youth Development, Tamil Nadu. I further declare that, the report is only prepared for my academic requirement, not for any other purpose.

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Place: Sriperumbudur

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the fieldwork report is the bonafide record of the original study carried out by Ms **FATHIMA RANA FOUMI** Enrolment No. **MASO24R204** under my supervision and guidance. To the best of my knowledge the work was carried out diligently and sincerely for meeting the requirements of the credit for the course. I wish her success for her future endeavours.

DR AVINU VERONICA RICHA

Supervisor

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Date: 02/12/2024

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FATHIMA RANA FOUMI

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CHAPETR I

INTRODUCTION

Fieldwork is a transformative process that allows students to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. As Clifford Geertz aptly stated, “Anthropology, or sociology, is an elaborate venture in ‘thick description’ not just reporting facts, but interpreting and understanding the webs of meaning within human life.” Fieldwork provides the context for such thick descriptions, enabling trainees to immerse themselves in the complex realities of human interaction and culture. Traditionally, the “field” referred to a specific geographic or cultural location where a society or group could be observed in its natural environment. However, with the evolution of sociology, the concept of the “field” has expanded to include diverse settings such as urban neighborhoods, digital communities, workplaces, hospitals, schools, and even virtual realities. The field is no longer a fixed space but a dynamic laboratory where sociologists analyze the interplay of structure, agency, and culture.

Fieldwork is instrumental in developing a nuanced understanding of how individuals and groups navigate their social worlds. It provides an opportunity for trainees to engage directly with people, observe social practices, and analyze the contexts that shape human behaviour. Through this process, trainees gain critical insights into how cultural norms, social structures, and power dynamics influence behaviors, attitudes, and relationships.

In the discipline of sociology, fieldwork is a vital tool for bridging theory and practice. It allows students to test sociological theories and concepts within real-life scenarios, fostering critical thinking and problem-solving skills. As Pierre Bourdieu noted, the goal of sociological research is to “make the familiar strange and the strange familiar.” Fieldwork offers this dual perspective, encouraging students to challenge their assumptions while fostering empathy and cultural sensitivity.

Our fieldwork, conducted from August 16th to December 23rd, 2024, was an endeavor to apply these sociological principles in practice. Working as a team comprising Fathima Rana Foumi, Kavya Mohan, Jitakshar Ballav Choudury, Nikita Behera, and Syed Abdullah Yasa Ali, we immersed ourselves in the field to understand social realities, develop professional competencies, and contribute meaningfully to our academic growth.

OBJECTIVES OF THE FIELD WORK

- To understand the socio-economic backgrounds of people in the society.
- To apply Sociological theories in societal issues and problems through practical exposure.
- To understand the functioning of the various social institutions in addressing the challenges and problems of the society.
- To attain professional development and to know the systematic application of knowledge into everyday situations.
- To improve communication skills, team spirit, time management and interpersonal relationship
- To understand the initiatives and innovative ideas implemented by NGO
- To gain exposure to diverse people and their social problems, and to understand the ways it is addressed.

CHAPTER II

ORGANISATIONAL PROFILE



Address: No.22, Viswasa Nagar, Koluthuvenchery, Paraniputhur, Iyyapathangal, Chennai, Tamil Nadu, 600122.

Working area: Mentally Disabled Women and Children

Rehoboth was founded in the year 2000 by Mrs. Zoraida Samuel as a public charitable trust with a desire to rescue, rehabilitate and mainstream women in distress and help them live life to its fullness with a sense of belonging. Their mission is to provide a safe haven and support services that facilitate reintegration into society. REHOBOTH prioritizes serving women marginalized by social stigma and poverty, who may also face mental health challenges. These women are often found on the streets, vulnerable to a range of dangers including starvation, infection, and physical violence.

Zoraida Samuel's Life Experiences encouraged her to give a ray of hope. So, she chooses social worker field to help mentally retarded and to support them by giving good medical care for them. The Rehoboth been started with three mentally ill people and with one pregnant woman. Now this organization rescued 1800 members, reunited 140 with their family and been rehabilitation 152 and more they are doing.

For over 20 years, Rehoboth has been working to uplift the lives of destitute women, who are mentally differently abled. The Organisation has two centres: one in Paraniputhur and the other one in Somamangalam. They also have a centre for rehabilitating mentally ill individuals and it also has special schools for differently abled children. And they have tailoring and embroidery units where staff works as well as the recovered inmates also help and assist the staff in making huge orders. They will be given token of appreciation. The Organisation has a kitchen unit where every meal is prepared for everyone and at times sponsor and donor provide funds for a meal.

Funding of the agency is purely from donation and sponsors and there is no foreign fund resources and the organisation maintains register for all the transactions, donations provided to them. The organisation takes students for internship and fieldworks and provides them with exposure to a rehabilitation home and the experiences of the diverse population of differently abled.

Vision/ Misson

Improving the quality of life of people with sub average mental functioning through rehabilitation based on their physical and mental capabilities and thus mainstreaming them as productive counterparts into the society. To ensure people live with dignity and hope, including those with below-average mental functioning through establishing rehabilitation programmes that cater to their physical and mental capacity and integrating them into all programmes. They mainly focusses on To run residential centres for the mentally disabled adult destitute, To initiate a crisis intervention centres to counsel and rehabilitate disabled women with their children, To initiate a community-based rehabilitation centre for special children from poor families, To spread awareness on causes and caring for the mentally challenged.

Motto

To reunite them with their family members and environmental change to destitute women.

Activities of the agency:

- 1) Rehabilitation work shop : To provide training such as candle making, tailoring, door hangings, bag making and other handicraft items. The inmate women who are all willing to contribute to the organisation are involved in helping the tailoring unit staff. The women from the home usually engage in small works related to stitching and they also involve in screen printing and packing bulk orders.
- 2) Day care centre: This programme is specially designed for the upliftment of the specially abled children from underprivileged families. They are made capable of doing their own chores by themselves. Under this programme, the mothers of those children are also provided with small employment opportunities.
- 3) Health care centre : Under this programme, free doctor consultation and subsidized medicines are provided for the rural poor and all the mentally ill women living in the shelter home.
- 4) Rehabilitation centre: This is located at Somangalam village 40 km away from Chennai. This centre provides long-term rehabilitation training such as agriculture, animal husbandry, piggery, poultry etc. for treated and not accepted individuals by their families and communities.
- 5) REST: Rehoboth Endeavour for stigmatised and traumatised (REST) – A Special care center for traumatised and stigmatised individuals.
- 6) Asai Pudhumai: A self-sustaining project for selling the used and usable household, electrical, electronic, furniture, dresses and other items donated by the donors and well-wishers.

CHAPTER III

ORGANIZATION STRUCTURE

The inmates were made to reside in different floors according to level of their retardation. The ground floor was for those who are completely need of assistance including their basic things. The first floor was for those who have better condition comparing to the ground floor people. The second floor was for those who have completely become and they're eligible for works and training. There was also a separate room with grills in between these sections. The staff introduced these for those who have an attacking or violent tendency so that they can be safe from others and within themselves. It's like an isolation room. They also have sedation room and a medical room and a mess, washing area etc. mainly they are two types of peoples there one is mentally ill by anxiety and other is mentally retrainability by birth.

And they have another building ground floor is office with special school, second floor also have a office with special school, therapy area, third floor they have tailoring unit. There is school bus for taking the childrens from their homes and in the evening return them to their homes. They also separate students according to their status including groups like educable 1, autism 2, 3, (severe, moderate) care group, occasional severe (above 14) and under occasional and occasional. The students are mostly mentally illness by birth.

They conducting parents meeting and showing their students progress and discussing initial caring for students. They were setting a goal, and need to be achieved and achievements list of each and every students. And also they were set up quarterly, half yearly, annual exams. Appointing of staff for this session is by basic experiences and skills. they got 8-14k salary. And they have progressing chart of every student. We clicks some pictures.

The REHOBOTH Institute of Songmangalam coordinated by Koteswari and her husband Maran. It's situated near to mettukolathoor village, Karunakarachery. It's an typical village area. They got license to shelter for mentally ill in 5/06/23.

Almost 87 inmates and 12 staff are there. They engaged in their community centre, Areca Plate making centre, 'ASAI' Thift Store, poultry / Ornamental Birds, Animal Husbandry Projects , Women Dorm and activities, ornamental fishes etc... they sell coconut oil, broom, eggs, hen, goat, cow, rabbit, pigeon etc in stalls. This plays an major role in finding funds. They going to hangout in a month or a week with sponsors.

They have A, B, C blocks B for inmates, C for accommodation of staffs, and resort, dormitory area, A block is under renovation work. LEO Block is also for accommodation for staffs who have night shift. They also help emergency situations. There is Auto rickshaw but it's not in working condition.

They get fund by CSR projects, donated by somebody, well wishers, occasional program donors, sponsors, and from their earnings from self sustaining projects like thrift store, Areca plate productions, tailoring and embroidering, plants and kitchen gardening, animal husbandry, poultry, piggy and pet shop etc.

We visited old home of Rehoboth. It's paid rehabilitation settlement. Ones they can't take care of the persons are dumped here and they provide fee for taking care of these persons including food also. They have TV room, spacious dining area, courtyard etc. They have fish and pet animal husbandry shops. And also they have a small shop with tea, coffee, biscuits and cool drinks. It also a method of earnings. They showcase their Palm leaf there to sell.

CHAPTER IV

ACTIVITIES CARRIED OUT AND LEARNING OUTCOMES

The Fieldwork for 1st Semester started from differently on August 16th to December 23rd 2024. A group of 4 of us went to Rehoboth Organisation in Paraniputhur which works mainly for the rescue and rehabilitation of mentally ill and abled women and also runs schools for special children. I completed 14 days of fieldwork. The activities assigned to us and the learning out of the works are mentioned below.

Activity Packing of donated books

The trainees clean the Book shelf in the organisation which is a small library setting for the special children. There were books that can be read by students of various grades. So we separated the books that are reader friendly for the specially abled children and arranged in the shelves and packed the rest of the academia, general knowledge toddler, dictionaries, journals, novels, activity books, gift books, disney books, cooking recipe books etc. and other books in boxes. Those books were planned to be kept in expo of few schools for students/parents to buy the books in second hand.

Learning outcome

The organisation is fully managed with the help of donations and sponsors from the society. There is register for maintaining each transaction, things, clothes and other items which are received through donation. Donators also arrange special food for the inmates time to time.

Activity Assistance in tailoring unit

The trainees helped in cleaning the whole tailoring unit of Paraniputhur. We also arranged the stitched bags and packed in the boxes. The trainees checked for the defect bags, arranged the stocks and engaged in screen printing work. And also we engaged in cutting bedsheets, putting handles in carry bag and count it.

Learning outcome

Contributing for the organisation by helping the staff in their works made me feel a sense of accomplishment. The cleaned environment after organising and arranging the areas made the trainee realise the need of keeping the surroundings neat and tidy and how it helps in maintaining the well-being of everyone in the environment.

Activity Documentation and maintenance of files

They have two types of file one is admission file and other one is medical file. In admission file they kept the details of the person who admitted including their admission started day photo and current photo. They took bank passbook, aadhar card, vaccination for them. And the medical file is used for recording their medical conditions.

The trainees Checked data of the monthly medical report of the inmates of Paraniputhur home and the sheet included their diagnosis, routine prescription, blood pressure and hygiene and arranged the medical files and reports of the patients in alphabetical order in the cupboard.

Learning outcome

Data entering and maintaining of information as documents helped me understand the importance of systematic procedures in completing the task and also the details can be taken as reference as well as used when required. The trainee also learnt that maintaining of records will help in smooth functioning of workflow as it can be verified anytime and further details can be added to it if necessary.

Activity Book stall in a school

The school's name is Tiaano Vidyashram CBSE School, security card checked and allow us to enter and we set up the books in separate sessions toddler, dictionaries, journals, novels, activity books, gift books, disney books, cooking recipe books etc.

We created badges of Rehoboth for us and set up and stick quotes about reading in doors, walls, and black board related to reading. parents and students visit our stalls and they purchase their favourable books, we treated them politely to that customers.

Learning outcomes

I realized the Nature of book stalls and how it's function in students and parents. And also a selection of books is not easy it will be take time. And the cover page of book and title play vital role for picking that book. More over the parents are more conscious about their students education and they choosing books suitable for increasing their reading habits.

Activity Visit to Somamangalam health centre

The trainees visited the Rehoboth centre in Somamangalam twice.

Learning outcome

The cleaning and folding of clothes made the trainee adapt to repetitive tasks without boredom and also helped in developing a sense of team spirit and cooperation with friends as well as the staff. Preparation of ledger is crucial for any organisation to maintain details in a chronological order which will be easier to find errors and discrepancies.

Activity Activities enhanced interpersonal and communication skills

Trainee tried to build communicating with the inmates and the trainee spoke to two inmates about their case history and they shared their experiences.

Learning outcome

The conversation with the inmates facilitated to enhance the trainee's empathetic listening skills and the selling of products to the students made me build rapport as well as the trainee learnt the necessity of the seller to understand the requirements of the customer and also created connections and developed good bonding with the staff, akkas and inmates of the organisation which helped me improve my interpersonal skills. Continuous field work helps to interact more with them and we got exact information from them. It's kind of data collection in directly not any secondary person between in this. That's helps our data more accurate and genuine.

Activity salary grants for special educators

The organisation runs a school for special children which follow the special education system. They hire special educators who have B.Ed. qualification in intellectual disability. These special educators are granted a salary increase from the state government. The students verified and arranged the certificates and documents of the applicants which is sent to the secretariat.

Learning outcome

The government scheme for special educators was a new knowledge in experience through which we came to know about the curriculum of the special education as well the variant qualifications that are required for securing a job as a special educator.

Activity Other assigned tasks

Trainees helped the staff to carry and arrange groceries and other resources and arranged the donated things and helped to segregate the things that can be put for sale in second hand as it will not be useful for the home and the organization. The trainees cleaned and arranged the store room for essentials of the inmates as the organisation planned for renovation and prepared charts about intellectual disability and mental illness.

Learning outcome

Chart work related to Intellectual Disability and Mental Illness helped trainee to become aware of the struggles and challenges faced by the individuals and how the family members cope up with it. Donation of things to NGO by the society depicted how NGOs and the people of the society are closely interlinked. The NGO makes effort to address the issues of marginalised people which is a great contribution to bring equality in the society and at the same time the society contributing to NGOs as donations, supporting by buying products show the responsibility that individuals hold to pay back.

CHALLENGES

- Travelling from the institution and the organisation was one of the challenge especially going to Somamngalam as the frequency of buses were limited
- Exposure to fieldwork and office work was quite less.
- The Rehabilitation home and the psychiatric environment were new to adapt but later I began communicating with the inmates and adapted to it.

SOCIOLOGICAL PERSPECTIVES

The well-known sociologist **Emile Durkheim** convey the idea **division of labour** in their works, all works are distributed to group of peoples and they engage only with that and also production (karl marx) increases based on the consumption and distribution of the products. They all are tried to keep customers mentioned demands. It's a type of forced labour. They have only 3 permanent workers come from outside others are that inmates. I noticed that they have Medication fatigue and illness so in sometimes they are not capable engage in activities. more over There is no religious stratification or social stratification. All are equal. There is an collective consciousness or solidarity between them in doing their work and religion or beliefs etc.

Research methodology paper we can see that so many barriers are faced by researchers to find out data. In Fieldwork, its very nature that it comes with a series of complexities and challenges that can often be unpredictable. In “**Reflections on Fieldwork in Morocco,**” **Paul Rabinow** candidly recounts the unexpected difficulties that arose during his anthropological journey and how he managed to navigate through them.

One of the significant challenges Rabinow faced was the language barrier. Even with prior preparation and learning some of the local language, the nuances and dialects within different regions of Morocco posed ongoing obstacles. It wasn't merely about understanding the words, but grasping the contexts in which they were used. Misinterpretations and miscommunications were commonplace, requiring Rabinow to continually refine his language skills and find more effective ways to connect with his informants.

Another striking challenge was dealing with the cultural differences in social interactions. Moroccan social customs and norms often differed drastically from what Rabinow was accustomed to necessitating a tremendous amount of **adaptability and patience**. For instance, the concept of **time and punctuality** in Morocco could be flexible, leading to frustrations when scheduled meetings or interviews did not occur as planned. Rabinow had to learn to recalibrate his expectations and adopt a more flexible approach to time management.

While in this field day I was going through the same situation. We're already delay to reach there because of the driver and also language barrier between the members of the institutions. Some members are ready to talk with us but we can't able to interact with them properly. Basically their words are blurry. One of the most profound ways Rabinow adapted to these complexities was by modifying his research focus and methodology in response to the field conditions. He discovered that rigidity in his approach would be counterproductive. Instead, Rabinow embraced a more fluid, responsive research strategy. This **adaptive methodology** involved iterative cycles of observation, interaction, and reflection, enabling him to hone in on what was truly significant within the local context. As like that we want to refer his methodology on data collection. I realized **observational skills** plays important role in the field.

Malinowski was a prominent anthropologist and ethnographer. His extensive fieldwork in Trobriand island gives a innovative research methods. He was given an exact idea about ethnography process and ethnography product. **Ethno** is a greek word which refers people and **grafy** is the word which means studying a particular context. His innovative use of participant observation allowed him to given a deep understanding of trobiand islanders culture, beliefs, social practices etc.

Ethnography is art and science of describing a group or culture. It's a systematic description through fieldwork it aims to provide thick description. As a qualitative methodology Malinowski try to study the beliefs, practices, social interactions and behaviours of the people through participant observation. So it's an **process**.

Ethnography as a product (i.e., ethnographic writings) the ethnographer writes the accounts of the culture he studied in descriptive detail which are ethnographer's personal and theoretical reflections and are available for readers. Ethnographic writing includes a detailed description that is presented in narrative form.

The purpose of the description is to let the reader understand what happened in the field and the participant's worldview in the research. It also gives a glimpse of the social reality as deciphered and interpreted by the researcher and later produced as an ethnographic text. The text mentions all the particular events and activities that happened when the researcher was in the field. It would also tell the reader about those events which may be worth exploring further. Malinowski defined the field work as a '**professional stranger**' (Agar, 1980), becoming embedded into a culture and conducting fieldwork through participant observation. In here the am collecting the data is a ethnography process and writing report is a product.

Studying a rehabilitation center through a **structural-functionalist perspective** involves examining how the center contributes **to maintaining social order, stability, and integration**. Structural functionalism, rooted in the works of **Emile Durkheim and Talcott Parsons**, emphasizes the role of institutions in fulfilling societal needs and ensuring the smooth functioning of society.

1. Function of the Rehabilitation Center in Society Restoring Individuals to Functionality:

Analyze how the center rehabilitates individuals (e.g., mentally ill, addicts, physically challenged) to reintegrate them into society as productive members. Reducing Social Strain: Discuss how it reduces social problems like homelessness, crime, or unemployment by addressing underlying issues of marginalized individuals. Social Solidarity: Explore how the center fosters a sense of belonging and community among residents and staff, reinforcing social bonds.

2. Structure and Roles within the Rehabilitation Center Hierarchy and Division of Labor:

Examine the roles of staff (e.g., doctors, counselors, social workers) and their functions in ensuring the center operates efficiently. Rules and Norms: Study the formal and informal rules guiding interactions, treatments, and daily routines, which help maintain stability within the center.

Socialization Processes: Investigate how residents are taught new norms, values, and behaviors to help them adapt to societal expectations.

3. Interdependence with Other Institutions Family: Assess how the center works with families to provide holistic care and support reintegration. Healthcare and Legal Systems: Explore collaborations with hospitals, clinics, and legal bodies in treating and rehabilitating individuals. **Economy and Education:** Highlight how vocational training or therapy programs prepare individuals for future employment or learning opportunities.

4. Latent and Manifest Functions

Manifest Functions: The explicit goals, such as providing therapy, treatment, and skill-building for individuals.

Latent Functions: Unintended consequences, such as reducing societal stigma around mental health or creating employment opportunities for professionals.

5. Addressing Dysfunction Challenges within the System: Identify issues like resource constraints, institutionalization effects, or failure to achieve rehabilitation goals. **Impact on Society:** Discuss potential dysfunctions, such as perpetuating dependency or stigmatization of residents post-rehabilitation.

By using this framework, you can analyze how rehabilitation centers not only address individual needs but also contribute to societal stability and cohesion. Celebrating festivals like **Diwali or Christmas on a rehabilitation institution** can be analyzed through various sociological perspectives, highlighting their social, cultural, and psychological significance.

Structural Functionalist Perspective

From this perspective, festivals serve as a means of promoting solidarity, integration, and stability within the institution: **Social Cohesion:** Celebrating festivals creates a sense of community and belonging among residents, staff, and families, reducing feelings of isolation. **Therapeutic Function:** Engaging in cultural rituals can aid emotional healing and reinforce positive behavior by fostering joy and hope. **Cultural Transmission:** Festivals allow residents to reconnect with cultural values and traditions, serving as a form of re-socialization. **Maintaining Order:** Structured celebrations provide routine and a sense of normalcy, crucial for individuals in rehabilitation.

Symbolic Interactionist Perspective

This perspective focuses on the meanings and symbols associated with festivals.

Shared Symbols: Lights of Diwali or the Christmas tree symbolize hope, renewal, and new beginnings, resonating with the journey of rehabilitation.

Social Interaction: Festivals provide opportunities for interpersonal bonding through shared activities like decorating, exchanging gifts, or preparing meals.

Identity Reconstruction: Residents may use the celebration to re-establish a positive self-identity, connecting with their cultural or spiritual roots.

Psychological and Sociological Benefits **Mental Health:** Festivals offer a break from routine and instill positivity, improving the mental well-being of residents. **Rehabilitation Goals:** Participating in group activities promotes teamwork, empathy, and interpersonal skills, aiding the reintegration process.

Spiritual Healing: For some, festivals provide spiritual solace, reinforcing hope and a sense of purpose.

Celebrating festivals like Diwali or Christmas in a rehabilitation institution is more than a cultural activity; it is a sociologically significant practice that fosters integration, emotional healing, and community bonding. By embracing diversity and inclusivity, such celebrations can create a microcosm of harmonious social life, preparing individuals for reintegration into the broader society.

Sociology of Myths Cultural Explanation of The belief that Amavasya generates “negative powers” is a myth that helps people explain unusual behaviors. In this case, it provided a reason for the inmate’s actions and guided how she was treated. Social Function explains Myths like this reduce uncertainty and give caregivers a sense of responsibility. They help maintain order and create guidelines for how to handle difficult situations. Abnormal Behavior of The inmate’s actions (screaming, biting, hitting) were seen as socially deviant, especially in the institutional setting.

She got punishment by Isolating her in a room reflects how institutions use discipline to manage deviance and ensure safety for others. Here we can see Labeling and Stigma of Belief in myths. It may lead to stigmatization, where the inmate is not only labeled as “abnormal” but also treated differently based on the day (Amavasya) Dragging the inmate shows how power operates in institutions.

The staff uses authority to control behavior and maintain stability. In India, mental health is often linked to spiritual or mythological ideas. This shapes how people behave and how care is provided. Despite the myth, the staff acknowledged their role in carefully taking care of the inmate, showing the balance between belief and duty.

From a sociological viewpoint, the **education of children in special schools** holds significant value not just for the individual but also for the larger society. The inclusion of children with disabilities in education systems contributes to social integration, equality, and personal development.

- **Social Integration and Inclusion Promoting Equality:** Education in special schools offers an opportunity for children with disabilities to be treated equally, with tailored support suited to their needs. It ensures they have access to education, which is a fundamental human right.

- **Breaking Social Barriers:** Special education helps to break the social stigma and stereotypes surrounding disabilities. It allows children to interact with their peers in a controlled, supportive environment, fostering mutual understanding and social integration.
- **Reducing Exclusion:** Special schools focus on integrating children into society. By providing specialized training and a structured environment, these schools reduce social exclusion and encourage empathy, which helps prevent societal marginalization.

Socialization and Development

1. **Building Social Skills:** Special schools foster social development through structured group activities. Children learn to cooperate, communicate, and navigate social dynamics, which are critical for their future social interactions in both personal and professional spheres.
2. **Role of Teachers and Peers:** The teachers and peers in special education settings play an important role in shaping the children's social behaviors. Teachers often act as role models, and peers in these settings learn the values of inclusion, patience, and empathy.
3. **Identity and Self-Esteem**
4. **Fostering Confidence:** Education provides children with disabilities the tools to understand their strengths and limitations. As they acquire knowledge and skills, their self-confidence improves, which positively impacts their identity and emotional well-being.
5. **Personal Empowerment:** Special education helps children with disabilities gain a sense of accomplishment and purpose. This empowerment is crucial for their ability to make choices, manage their lives independently, and pursue future opportunities.

Social Mobility

- **Breaking the Cycle of Poverty and Dependency:** Special education enables children with disabilities to achieve a level of independence and skills that can promote upward social mobility. By acquiring literacy, numeracy, and life skills, these children can break free from dependency and pursue careers that offer greater autonomy.
- **Access to Opportunities:** Education opens the door to economic opportunities and a better quality of life. When special school children are educated, they have access to a wider array of possibilities for employment and social engagement, which ultimately supports their personal growth and the economic health of society.

The context of the **rehabilitation center, where inmates are given coupons (tokens) to buy items** based on their work, this process can be understood through the lens of sociological theories of gift-giving. It is an important symbolic gesture that serves multiple functions, both emotional and social, within the institution.

To analyze this concept sociologically, we can apply Marcel Mauss's seminal work on the sociology of gifts and the idea of symbolic exchange.

Marcel Mauss and the Gift In his work "**The Gift**" (1925), Marcel Mauss explored the idea of gift exchange and its role in social relationships. He argued that gifts are not simply material exchanges, but carry social obligations. Gifts create bonds of reciprocity between the giver and receiver, even when there is no immediate material expectation in return.

In the rehabilitation center example, the coupon can be seen as a gift from the institution to the inmates for their work. Though framed as a **token of love**, this gift functions within a system of social obligations.

- **Reciprocity:** Inmates receive the coupon based on their work performance, which implies that the coupon is not just given out of affection but is a reward for labor. This reinforces the relationship between work and reward, showing that social behavior (working) leads to tangible benefits (coupons).
- **Symbolic Value:** The coupon, as a gift, carries more than just its monetary value. It symbolizes recognition and appreciation for the inmates' efforts. It also indicates a sense of control and regulation, where the institution defines what the inmates can purchase and limits their autonomy in certain ways. While the coupon can be seen as a token of love, from a sociological perspective, it also functions as a form of social control. The institution provides the coupon as a way to reward "acceptable" behavior (work and cooperation) and incentivize continued compliance with the rules. It reflects the concept of structured rewards in institutional settings.
- **Regulation of Desire and Choice:** By controlling the items that can be bought with the coupon, the institution guides the inmates' consumption. They can choose personal items, but only within the boundaries set by the coupon value. This practice subtly encourages conformity by making inmates feel appreciated while also maintaining control over their choices.

Mauss discussed the power dynamics involved in gift-giving. the institution holds power over the inmates because they define the terms of **exchange**. The gift (coupon) is a method of maintaining institutional control while simultaneously fostering a relationship of affection and recognition.

On the emotional level, the coupon can be understood as a symbol of affection and recognition. **The “token of love” is an expression of the institution’s care and concern for the inmates’** well-being. It can increase feelings of self-worth and belonging as it acknowledges their contributions and efforts, fostering a sense of pride and individuality

However, this emotional exchange may also reflect societal norms that link work with reward, reinforcing ideas of worth based on productive labor. This type of system can be empowering for some individuals who feel a sense of achievement through work, while others might view the process as transactional or paternalistic.

In the rehabilitation center, the tailoring unit follows a **specific duty chart** where each inmate is assigned a particular task based on their skills and abilities. This division of labor ensures that the work process is organized and efficient, with individuals contributing to the collective goal of producing items like clothes or other textiles.

From a sociological perspective, this can be linked to **Émile Durkheim’s** concept of the **division of labor**, where he discusses how specialization in tasks contributes to social cohesion and the functioning of society. Durkheim argued that in modern societies, the division of labor helps integrate individuals into a system of interdependence, where each person’s role, though specialized, is essential to the larger social structure. In the context of the rehabilitation center, the duty chart reflects **mechanical solidarity** if the tasks are uniform and highly regulated, or **organic solidarity** if the tasks require varied skills and interdependent collaboration. This structure not only increases productivity but also fosters a sense of social order and mutual dependence, where each individual’s contribution is valued, helping to maintain harmony within the unit and broader institution.

Erving Goffman's dramaturgical approach in his work **The Presentation of Self in Everyday Life (1959)** provides a powerful framework for understanding how individuals present themselves in social settings. Goffman compares social life to a theatrical performance, where individuals are like actors on a stage, performing different roles based on the social context. The front stage is where the public performance occurs, and the back stage is where individuals prepare and rehearse for their roles

In the context of the rehearsing Christmas dance

Front Stage: The actual performance of the dance during the Christmas celebration can be seen as the front stage, where inmates act according to the expectations of the institution and their peers. In this setting, they are expected to present themselves in a certain way dancing, smiling, and participating as a collective group. This is a social performance in which they are aware of how they are being observed and judged, either by their fellow inmates or the staff, and they adjust their behavior accordingly.

Back Stage: The back stage is where the inmates practice and prepare for the dance. Here, they can relax and rehearse their roles without the pressure of an audience. The back stage is crucial for role preparation, where individuals can express their true selves more freely, away from the gaze of others. This is where the individualization of the self occurs, and they refine their roles before presenting them in the front stage.

Mead's theory emphasizes the importance of social interaction and role-taking in the development of the self. In this case, as inmates practice for the Christmas dance, they are engaging in role-taking, where each individual imagines how they should behave and what role they should play in this social setting (e.g., the dancer, the performer, the organizer). Through these roles, they develop their sense of self, shaped by their interactions with the group.

Medical Power and Social knowledge is a book written By Bryan .S. Turner who is a British and Australian sociologist.

In 1987, when Medical Power and Social Knowledge first appeared, Medical sociology was typically an applied social science with a commitment to problems defined by medical research agencies rather than by the sociological community.

In contemporary medical sociology, there is now a much stronger sense of the importance of theory and a definite engagement with mainstream sociological issues. The sophistication of the debate about the socially constructed nature of disease in journals like the Sociology of Health and Illness would be an obvious example of these developments. The criticisms of medical sociology are essentially concerned with the relationship between sociology and medical institutions. An examination of this relationship between medicine and sociology then leads eventually to a critical appraisal of the content and topics of medical sociology. The so-called ambiguity of sociology in relation to medicine is expressed in terms of a dichotomy between **sociology-in-medicine and the sociology-of-medicine**.

In this study of medical sociology, Turner is concerned particularly with the relationship between knowledge and power in the social distribution of health and illness, and as the basis for professional management of socially deviant individuals. That is, the argument will be concerned with the role of medical discourse(which contains distinction between deviance, illness and disease) as the foundation of medical power.

Sociology in medicine is defined as dominated by medical values and professional needs, whereas, the sociology of medicine/health & illness has traditionally been concerned with the nature of medicine as a profession, and embodies a shift away from the doctor's perspective on illness towards the client's view of their condition.

The focus of the **sociology of medicine** has included the recruitment of doctors, their training, the development of the roles of doctors, paramedicals and patients, and the professionalisation of medical and paramedical occupations.

It also embraces the study of medical organisations with special reference to such institutions as the clinic, and the asylum and the General hospital within the framework of a sociological study. According to Turner, the sociology of medicine, is primarily a study in sociology & not a study in medicine, should be more concerned to identify itself with the central theoretical problems of the sociology as such. For him, sociology can better serve the practical problems and needs of patients by formulating sociological rather than medical questions.

Disease, illness and sickness

In this study of medical sociology, Turner is concerned particularly with the relationship between knowledge and power in the social distribution of health and illness, and as the basis for professional management of socially deviant individuals. That is, the argument will be concerned with the role of medical discourse (which contains distinction between deviance, illness and disease) as the foundation of medical power.

Medical sociology now propose a neat and economic classification of human disorders into three distinct categories:

Disease is a concept which describes malfunctions of physiological and biological character, **illness** refers to the individual's subjective awareness of the disorder, and **sickness** designates appropriate social roles. It can be argued that this tripartite division of human disorders corresponds to a professional division of labour and to prestige ranking of medical activity. There is also a hierarchy of scientific status in which the analysis of sick roles is perceived to be the most underdeveloped aspect of medical practice from the point of view of precision, accuracy and reliability. Disease is seen as a neutral and natural entity residing in nature, that is in the body of the patient. The division between physical and mental illness corresponds to a cultural division between mind and body, which is in fact philosophically and social logically very problematic. It is argued that an adequate medical sociology would require a sociology of body, since it is only by developing a notion of social embodiment that we can begin adequately to criticise the conventional divisions between mind and body, individual and society. In REHOBOTH institution we can see that inmates are feels illness and they were engaged in other activities. It also involved in sociology of medicine and sociology in medicine. As like Turner's findings They feels illness, diseases, sickness. it showing some similarities.

Sociological Document Analysis is an essential tool that offers unique insights into social behaviors and cultural patterns. By examining various documents, researchers can uncover underlying narratives that shape societies. This analytical method helps highlight the significance of textual artifacts, such as newspapers and correspondence, revealing societal values, norms, and historical contexts.

Furthermore, the process of Sociological Document Analysis allows sociologists to engage with diverse perspectives, fostering a comprehensive understanding of community dynamics. This approach is crucial for studying the social implications of policies and practices, enabling researchers to contribute meaningfully to discussions on social change and advocacy. In this way, document analysis becomes a valuable pathway for sociological inquiry and social understanding. There are various methodologies guide researchers in extracting meaning from documents.

- These approaches enable scholars to understand social contexts, patterns, and narratives present within texts. While the methods can vary significantly, they generally center on qualitative and quantitative techniques for examining written materials, such as interviews, public records, and media content. Understanding these methodologies allows sociologists to derive insights that inform broader sociological theories and applications.
- Key methodologies in this analysis include content analysis, thematic analysis, and discourse analysis. Content analysis focuses on quantifying specific elements within documents, providing a systematic way to identify trends. Thematic analysis, on the other hand, involves identifying key themes and patterns that represent the core ideas within the texts. Discourse analysis investigates the language and context used in documents to uncover underlying social dynamics.
- By employing these methodologies, researchers can effectively interpret and critique the social implications contained in various written forms. In here the documented files of registration, death, initial physical assessment, processing report of child, health reports helps to collect more data about the inmates.

Organizing a book fair by a rehabilitation center is a meaningful initiative that combines education, community engagement, and fundraising for a noble cause.

Here's a simple explanation:

1. Purpose and Impact: The book fair is organized to raise funds for the rehabilitation center, supporting its programs and beneficiaries. It helps create awareness about the center's work and mission.

2. Wide Range of Books: Includes novels, journals, bedtime stories, activity books, and subject-related books to cater to all age groups and interests. Encourages people to explore different genres and promote reading habits.

3. Community Participation: Invites schools, families, and the local community to participate, fostering social inclusion and support for the center.

Engages volunteers and residents of the center, giving them an active role in the event.

4. Educational and Social Value: Promotes literacy and learning among attendees, making books accessible to all. Strengthens the connection between the rehabilitation center and the community by showcasing its efforts and talent.

5. Fundraising for a Cause: Proceeds from the book sales directly contribute to the rehabilitation center's activities, ensuring sustainability. Encourages attendees to support a good cause while enjoying the fair.

Organising a book fair is a great way to celebrate writing, bring together people who are passionate about literature, and share and discover new styles and types of books. Whether it is an event for your local library, school or community centre, organising a book fair requires preparation and organisation

Here are 7 key steps to organising a successful book fair:

1. Define the types of books and authors that will be exhibited.
2. The choice of venue
3. Organise your book fair by book category
4. Search for sponsors
5. Preparing activities
6. Hiring the staff you need
7. Communicate about your fair

CHAPTER V

CONCLUSION

The fieldwork experience at Rehoboth Rehabilitation Centre for mentally challenged women has been a profound journey of understanding and learning. This institution stands as a testament to the power of compassion, patience, and resilience in addressing the challenges faced by mentally challenged women. The center not only provides care and shelter but also fosters a sense of dignity and inclusion for its residents.

Through direct observation and interaction, I have gained insights into the complexities of mental health, the importance of a supportive environment, and the role of tailored rehabilitation in promoting recovery and social reintegration. The dedicated efforts of the staff highlight the necessity of holistic care that encompasses emotional, physical, and psychological well-being.

This fieldwork has deepened my sociological perspective, reinforcing the critical role of institutions like Rehoboth in bridging societal gaps and advocating for marginalized populations. It also emphasizes the urgent need for greater societal awareness, government support, and inclusive policies to address the stigma surrounding mental health.

Overall, the experience has been transformative, inspiring me to contribute toward creating a more inclusive society where every individual, irrespective of their mental condition, is treated with respect and compassion.

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Doctors list

General medical Doctor	Prema, roslin sisters
Physcatric Doctor	
Residential Doctor	Geetha, amala sister

ANNEXURE – 2

[illegible]

Register of the inmates in tailoring unit

ANNEXURE – 3

DISTRIBUTION OF RESPONSIBILITIES AMONG WORKSHOP TEAM

S.NO	Name of staff	Responsibility
1.	SARASU MUTHU	- Working out Cost Estimate for orders - stock maintenance - Stitching - Designing new bags
2.	MARY DAISA	- Receiving raw material entering in ledger - Liaisoning with customers and entering in ledgers - intimating respective staff about communications. - Stitching
3.	JOTHI	- Operating computer - correspondence through mail - submitting estimates and delivery details to customer. - Bill making - Stitching
4.	QUEEN	- Maintenance of movement register - Packing for delivery- - counting and sending material for outside work. - Stitching
5.	MARY SITHER	- Quality check of products before delivery. - counting of number before dispatch(video graphing) - stitching
6.	AMUDHAMMA	- Asisting in quality check - stock maintenance - Waste Management - Stitching

Distribution list of responsibilities (tailoring unit)

ANNEXURE 4



TRAINEES ENGAGING WITH IN MATES, DOING CLEANING WORK, SEPARATING BOOKS ACCORDING TO DIFFERENT CATEGORIES AND SETTING FOR PACKING THOSE FOR BOOK STALLS



**INTERACTING WITH STUDENTS, BOOK STALL, MEDICINE ROOM,
REHOBOTH OLD AGE HOME, REHOBOTH SPECIAL SCHOOL
CHILDREN'S CLASSROOM, NEW COMPUTER SYSTEM**

REHOBOT SPECIAL SCHOOL, PARANIPUTHUR
 Madras Developmental Programming System Behavioural Profile

Name: Abdul Kahir Term: June to September Attendance: _____

Name of the teacher: S. Kalavani

Domains	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	Evaluation	
																					Blue	Red
1. Gross Motor Activities																					13	7
2. Fine Motor Activities																					20	0
3. Manual Time Activities																					15	5
4. Dressing																					14	6
5. Grooming																					14	6
6. Toileting																					15	5
7. Receptive Language																					15	5
8. Expressive Language																					15	5
9. Social Interaction																					15	5
10. Reading																					15	5
11. Writing																					15	5
12. Numbers																					15	5
13. Time																					15	5
14. Money																					15	5
15. Domestic Activities																					15	5
16. Community Orientation																					15	5
17. Recreation/ Leisure Time																					15	5
18. Vocational Activities																					15	5

Date: _____ Signature of the Principal: _____

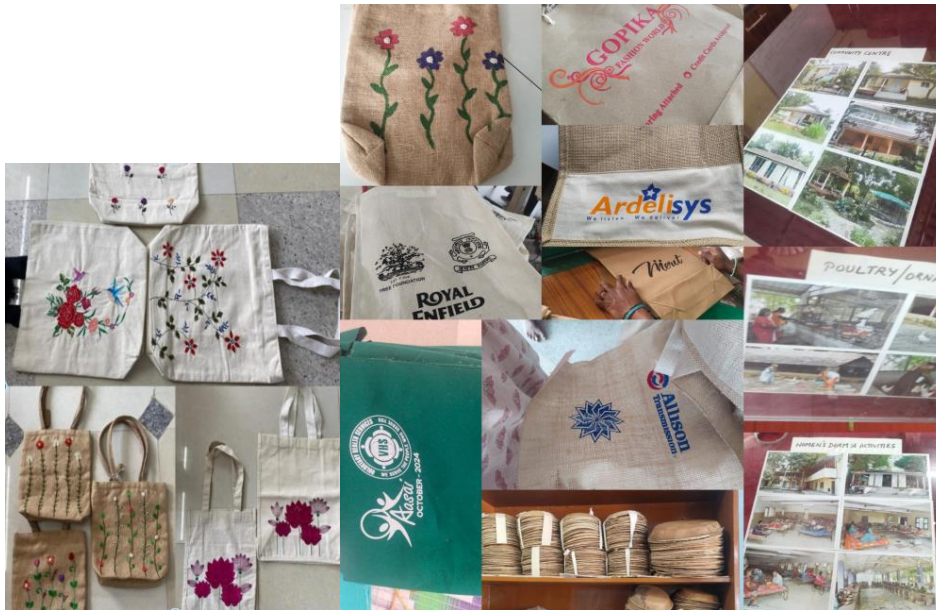
BEHAVIOURAL PROFILE OF SPECIAL STUDENTS



TRAINEES AT SONGMANGALAM BRANCH



CHECKING FOR DEFECTS IN THE JUTE BAGS



PRODUCTS MADE BY THE TAILORING UNIT STAFF AND INMATES.



LAST DAY OF FILED WORK

ANNEXURE 5

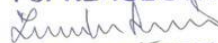
Rajiv Gandhi National Institute of Youth Development (RGNIYD) (An Institute of National Importance by an Act of Parliament) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
Government of India
Sriperumbudur, Tamil Nadu
M.A. SOCIOLOGY
2022 - 2024 Batch
Department of Sociology

Assessment of the Agency Supervisor

Name of the Student : FATHIMA RANA FOUMI
Enrolment Number :
Course : M.A. SOCIOLOGY
Duration of fieldwork : 16th Aug to 24th Nov 2024

Sl. No.	Criteria for Assessment	Marks Awarded	Maximum Marks
1.	Punctuality • Regularity in attending work • Quality of assigned work • Finishing assigned tasks on time submission of report on time	4 3 3	5 5 5
2.	Professional involvement Ability to work with others • Professional demeanor • Professional appearance • Use of time management skills • Judgment/decision making skills • Show initiative & work with limited supervision • professional level of flexibility & adaptability • Contribution to the organization	5 5 4 2 2 3 3	5 5 5 5 5 5 5
Total		34	50

Signature of the Agency Supervisor
Designation

For REHOBOTH

MANAGING TRUSTEE

ANNEXURE 6

	REHOBOTH PUBLIC CHARITABLE TRUST No.22 & 23, Viswasa Nagar, Koluthuvanchery, Paraniyuthur Post, Chennai-600122. E-mail : rehoboth2000@gmail.com Website : www.rehobothshelter.org	☎ : 26792852 Cell : 9884080863 9884189115
Ref. : RE/1114/24		Date : 28.11.24
TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN		
This is to certify that Ms.Fathima Rana Foumi has completed 14 days of fieldwork placement at our shelter for mentally challenged women. Ms.Fathima Rana was punctual, flexible and committed in her work schedule and supported the rehabilitation team in their efforts to improve the quality of life of our women. Her work included : 1. One on one work with women at the rehabilitation unit 2. Organising and arranging store rooms 3. Planning on display and sale of items in the thrift store. 4. Representing the shelter in stalls for sale of rehabilitation products. 5. Filing and maintenance of office records. Wishing her the very best in all her future endeavours!		
For REHOBOTH  MANAGING-TRUSTEE Zoraida Samuel Managing Trustee		
Income Tax Exemption under Section 12A of the Income Tax Act of 1961 PAN No. AAATR5577R		